Familiar safe steps

Use steps you know. Keep your usual aids. No one has to feel upset. Stop or choose a new card if a step does not suit you.

Soft breath

1. Sit or stand in your safe, usual way.
2. Take a soft breath in.
3. Let a soft breath out at your own pace.
4. Stop or ask for help if it does not feel good.

Look and count

1. Look at three things you can see.
2. Notice two safe touch points, like feet and a seat.
3. Notice one sound in the quiet room.
4. Stop or choose another card if you wish.

Small hand move

1. Sit in your safe, usual way.
2. Rest your hands where they feel fine.
3. Open softly. Close softly. Let them rest.
4. Stop or choose another card if you wish.

Soft breath: no hold, no force, your own pace. Look and count: use the quiet room and safe touch points. Hand move: no tight grip or force.

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Ask for safe help

Ask a trusted adult

1. Choose a trusted adult role for the story.
2. Use words, a help card or your usual aid.
3. Ask for help with the next step.
4. If the adult is busy, try another trusted adult.

Ask for agreed quiet space

1. Use a help card, words or your usual aid.
2. Ask the adult for the agreed quiet space.
3. Use the space with the agreed adult support.
4. Return with help when ready.

Safe route

Use an adult you know and trust. Use the help or quiet-space route agreed at school. Stay with the agreed adult support. Do not go off alone to a new adult or place.

A request is a step

Use the card, words or your usual aid to make your chosen request. The adult can voice the words you pick. Saying what a story pupil might do is a plan; show your chosen request to the adult.

Use the made-up stories in class. For real help, ask a trusted adult in private. You can stop, pass or ask for help.

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Three mild story stations

All stories are made up. The room stays calm and quiet. You can try one safe step you know. You do not have to finish all three.

A A change of plan

A pupil thought the class would draw first. The new plan is to tidy first, then draw. The pupil says, 'I feel cross.'

Who could help? Which strategy could fit?

B A noisy room story

Lots of people talk in a room. A pupil wants a calm moment.

Which safe step could the pupil show?

C A task feels hard

A pupil looks at a new task. They say, 'I am not sure how to start.'

Who could help and how? What strategy could fit?

Your choice

Pick a familiar card. Show its safe steps or make the chosen help request. Your words, model and usual aids stay. You can use one safe step for more than one story.

No loud noise, surprise change or hard task will be made. You can stop, pass, watch or come back with help.

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My strategy that works

A card to help me choose next time

Keep this card. Write, draw, point or ask for a scribe if you wish.

Today I tried

_____

A next safe step

_____

Did it help?

My own check	My tick
Yes	
A bit	
No	
Not sure	

A next choice

What I could do	My tick
Try this again	
Try another safe step	
Not sure yet	

All answers are fine. Any space can stay blank. The title does not mean a step must work each time. No real worry, private story or adult name goes here. You do not have to show this card to the group. Keep it.

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Aids for the story tasks

Keep words, start and model in view. Your usual aids stay.

Story starter

Words: pupil, change, cross, help

Start: The story pupil could try ... .

Model: The story pupil could try a small hand move.

Model check

Words: choose, show, step, help

Start: They show the step by ... .

Model: They show a small hand move: open softly, close softly, rest.

Guided circuit practice

Words: breath, move, help, space

Start: For story ... they could ... .

Model: For the noisy-room story they could ask for agreed quiet space.

Private hinge

Words: card, show, try, help

Start: We need to see ... .

Model: We need to see the chosen safe steps, not just a card choice.

Use the stories in class. You can point, use an aid or pass. To show a physical step, do the safe action; a scribe cannot do it for you.

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Aids for your safe try

Choose and plan

Words: choose, step, stop, adult

Start: In the story, they will try ... .

Model: In the story, they will try soft breath at their own pace.

Show and own check

Words: try, stop, help, sure

Start: They showed ... . My check is ... .

Model: They showed a hand move. The help tick is their own choice.

Feedback and exit

Words: next, help, adult, card

Start: A next safe step could be ... .

Model: A next safe step could be to ask a trusted adult.

Your next step

Keep your first try. Use one next step. Reply in the same colour, on the same page or usual mode.

Help in private

For real help, ask a trusted adult in private. Use your known school route and agreed adult support. If one adult is busy, ask another trusted adult. You can stop, pass or come back with help.

No real worries or names in class work. Your keep card stays with you. You do not have to say a step helped.

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